SOP-QA-023 Deviation Management and CAPA (Rev 2)

Aurora Nutraceuticals Inc. · Controlled document · For training and demonstration only

1. Purpose

This procedure (SOP-QA-023) describes how deviations from approved procedures, specifications or validated conditions are reported, classified, investigated and closed, and how corrective and preventive actions (CAPA) are managed at Aurora Nutraceuticals Inc.

2. Classification

Minor deviation: no impact on product quality, safety or efficacy, and no regulatory commitment affected. Major deviation: potential impact on product quality or a departure from a registered process parameter that is contained within the batch. Critical deviation: a confirmed or probable impact on product quality, safety or efficacy, a possible market action, or a breach of data integrity.

3. Reporting

Any employee who discovers a deviation reports it to Quality Assurance within 24 hours of discovery using form F-023-01. A suspected critical deviation is reported to the Quality Assurance Manager by telephone within 4 hours of discovery and the affected material is placed on hold immediately.

4. Investigation

4.1 Quality Assurance assigns a deviation number and an investigation owner within one working day.

4.2 The investigation, including root cause analysis, impact assessment and proposed CAPA, must be completed within 30 calendar days of the report. One extension of at most 30 additional days may be approved by the Head of Quality with a documented justification.

4.3 Root cause analysis uses the 5 Whys method for minor deviations and an Ishikawa (fishbone) diagram for major and critical deviations. 'Human error' is not an acceptable root cause without an analysis of the contributing conditions.

5. Approval and Closure

Minor and major deviations are closed by the Quality Assurance Manager. Critical deviations are closed only by the Head of Quality, after review of the investigation report and the CAPA plan. No batch affected by an open deviation may be released; the batch disposition decision is recorded on the deviation form.

6. CAPA

Each CAPA has an owner and a due date. Corrective actions remove the root cause; preventive actions stop recurrence elsewhere. A CAPA effectiveness check is performed 90 days after the CAPA is implemented and must show that the deviation has not recurred. An ineffective CAPA reopens the investigation.

7. Trending

Quality Assurance trends deviations quarterly by classification, department and root cause category and presents the trend at the management review. Three deviations with the same root cause within 12 months trigger a system-level CAPA.